

LEADING THE WAY IN CHRONIC LYMPHOCYTIC LEUKEMIA

Faculty at Columbia University's Vagelos College of Physicians and Surgeons are on the forefront of our growing understanding and treatment of chronic lymphocytic leukemia (CLL), a slow-growing cancer that affects white blood cells known as lymphocytes. Our pioneering doctors and scientists are learning more about the origins and expressions of CLL, and turning that new knowledge into better and more effective treatment for patients. It's what makes us the destination of choice for the very best investigators, the most promising medical students, residents, and fellows, and of course for patients who are faced with this significant but treatable diagnosis.



NICOLE LAMANNA, MD

Dr. Lamanna is a groundbreaking investigator and internationally recognized leader in CLL. As the inaugural incumbent of the Judy Horrigan Professorship of Medicine, she has been able to expand Columbia's CLL research efforts, raise the public profile of the diagnosis, and pursue the most promising avenues of research for its treatment. Her work has been widely published in peer-reviewed journals including *Blood*, *The New England Journal of Medicine*, *The Journal of Clinical Oncology*, *eJHaem*, *Blood Advances*, and *Clinical Lymphoma, Myeloma & Leukemia*, which have informed both academic research and frontline patient care.

Dr. Lamanna has also been an invited speaker at major national and international forums, including the American Society of Hematology (ASH) Annual Meeting, the European Hematology Association (EHA), and the Society of Hematologic Oncology (SOHO), where she has presented on cutting-edge developments in targeted therapies, emerging agents, and personalized approaches to CLL treatment.

Dr. Lamanna's combination of innovative research, clinical expertise, paradigm-shifting approaches to the diagnosis, and substantial track record of progress are singular – and she and her team are transforming the ways in which we think about the diagnosis. CLL has shifted from a disease with a dire prognosis to a chronic condition that can be treated for the duration of a patient's life. Although curative therapy remains a goal, many CLL patients can now live to an average life expectancy due to many of the therapies currently FDA-approved through trials Dr. Lamanna has led at Columbia.

In addition, Dr. Lamanna is a staunch patient advocate, and continues to educate at patient symposiums, aiming to help patients understand their disease, ask the right questions of their providers, and seek guidance if they do not have access to a CLL expert. She prides herself not only in the cutting-edge treatment she can offer her CLL patients through her clinical trial efforts, but also the excellent care her patients receive from her and her team.